

Chromebooks will run Linux in a desktop window!

It has become a lot easier to use Linux on your Chromebook. Till now, you could use Linux in Chromebook virtual terminals with the help of Crouton, but a new extension by Crouton developer and Google hardware engineer, David Schneider, will allow running Debian or Ubuntu in a window within the Chrome OS interface.



The extension will look good if you are using Linux along with the Chrome OS. The setting up process will also be smoother. If someone is in the developer mode, then after downloading the Crouton extension and tool from the Chrome Web store, the hidden terminal commands can be used in the Chrome OS.

It's not a very stressful process but if you are a typical Chromebook user and only use LibreOffice and Skype, then the installation guide by Francois Beaufort will be really helpful. This latest development is important as one of the biggest drawbacks of Chromebooks has been that only Web-based software could be used on these devices, and they could not be used in offline mode. Now that you will be able to run a Linux distro in a separate window, it will increase functionality.

Chrome OS' software library has received a huge boost in 2014, as Photoshop and Skype have moved to the Web, and it can also run Android apps. If you install Wine on your Linux OS, then Windows programs can also be run on Chromebooks. The new development means you don't even need to switch back and forth while running Linux inside the window. The extension is Crouton Integration, and the only issue is it still requires the developer mode.

Spotify will be available on Ubuntu Phones too, though unofficially

It's up to third-party developers to launch Spotify on the Ubuntu Phone as it will take a while to launch it officially as an Ubuntu Phone app. However, unofficially, the latest update is 'Cute Spotify', which has all the latest features and toolkits in Ubuntu for the developer builds for phones and tablets.



Cute Spotify, developed by Mike Sheldon, uses the official music streaming service's API, and it allows premium subscribers to log in and stream content to their device directly. The app functions like the official Spotify apps on Android and iOS. It can set music streaming to work over Wi-Fi or cellular networks. It works in a basic way when used offline and brings up content, based on what is most popular.

The latest version also offers support to handle Spotify URLs. If someone clicks on such a link in a tweet, the app opens. Cute Spotify will not offer Facebook integration though, and the service also does not feature too many visuals like the official apps of Spotify. The app will also not run in the background. While streaming this app, if you switch to another app, then the music will also stop playing.

This paid-for kernel patch can boost the Linux kernel's performance

The latest Linux patch boosts the kernel's performance and addresses power efficiency issues on Linux systems. The eXt73 patch-set promises significant performance improvements. However, this patch is not available for free.

A team of developers from Poland has designed the patch, eXt73, to provide great performance with minimal power consumption as compared to the generic Linux kernel image. The development work is quite polished. According to the test reports, the patch really helps in boosting the performance of Linux systems.



According to Phoronix Test suite benchmark results, eXt73 is faster than the mainline kernel. If you look at the pricing, it is not very high either. eXt73 can be installed for US\$ 15 per system. You can download the patch from netext73.pl. The open source code is available on GitHub.

The developers want users to patch the kernel in binary form. Currently, all the changelog and work details are given on the GitHub page only in the Polish language. We can know the details only when the translated version is available. For power users, this could be a very useful patch to boost the performance of a system.